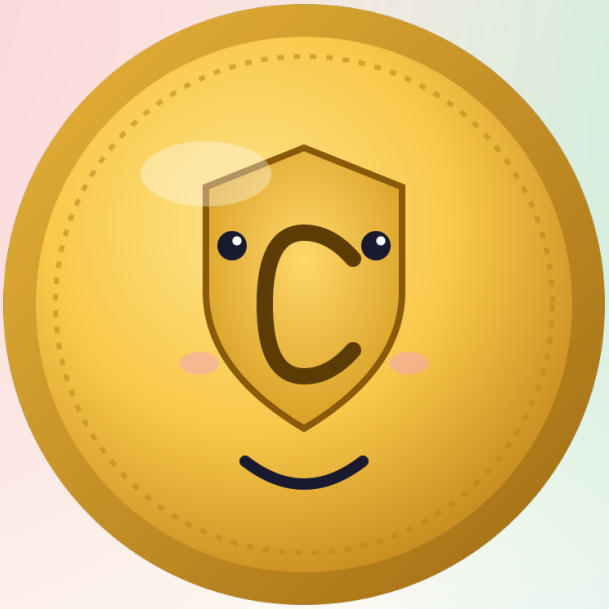


GRADE K

Curriculum Book

C A S H

Businesses help people.

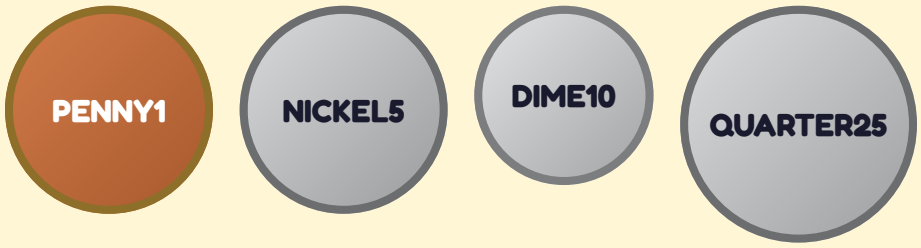
The year, big ideas, vocabulary, and project arc.

Grade K — Cash to Company: Curriculum Book

Year theme: Businesses help people **Grade band:** K-2 (early elementary, picture-first) **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 30–45 minutes per week (one short block, broken into 2–3 mini-bursts) **Anchor mascot:** Cash, the program's animated host

Why this year

Five-year-olds are noticers. They watch the bus driver wave. They watch the cook flip a pancake. They watch the dentist's gloves go on and come off. The first job of Cash to Company is to take that built-in noticing muscle and gently point it at one big idea: **businesses help people.**



We do not teach business as money this year. We teach it as helpers. The mail carrier helps. The librarian helps. The shoe-store grown-up helps you find shoes that fit. Each one is a business, and each one

helps in a real, observable way. Naming the helper is the first step toward understanding the world that older grades will unpack in detail.

The financial spine of the year is small and concrete: **coins.** A penny, a nickel, a dime, a quarter. We hold them. We name them. We say which one is more. That is the year's whole money task. It is enough.

The classroom spine is **dramatic play.** Children take turns being the shopkeeper and the customer. They set out pretend pretzels at "Cash's Cafe" and trade pretend coins. They learn the muscles of taking turns, using kind words, and finishing a small classroom job. None of it is rushed.

The big ideas (Stage 1)

These are the year's understandings, written so a five-year-old can hear them. Every unit, every lesson, and every Cash video circles back to one or more.

1. **People do jobs that help us.** A helper is a kind of business.
2. **Coins have names. Coins have sizes. Some coins are worth more than others.**
3. **Things happen in order.** A sandwich gets made step by step. A helper does jobs in order, too.
4. **We take turns.** When we play store, we trade roles. We use kind words for shopkeeper and customer.

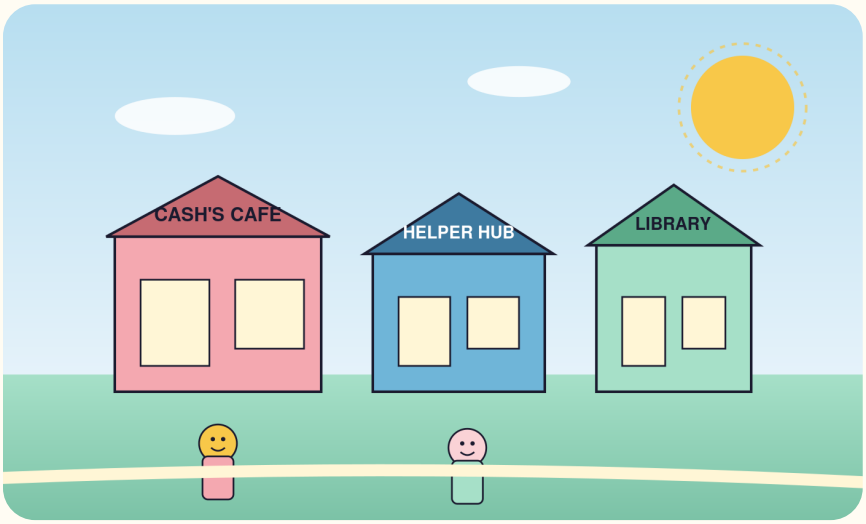
5. **A job is finished when it is finished the right way.** Putting napkins on every table is a job. We can tell when it is done.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

- Who is a helper today?
- What did the helper do?
- Which coin is more?
- What comes first? What comes next? What comes last?
- How will I know when my job is done?

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

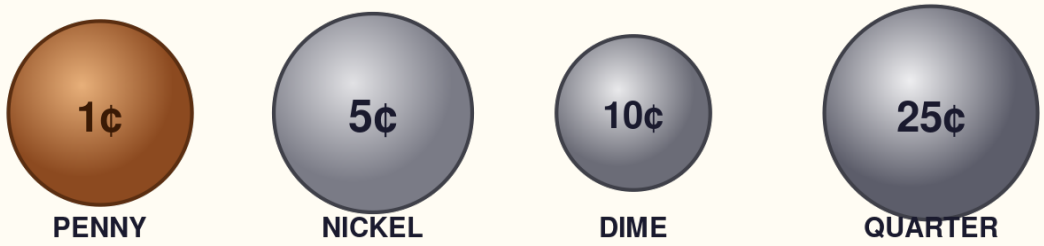
Year-at-a-glance — four units

Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor activity
1	1–9	Helpers all around us	People do jobs that help us.	A class "Helpers Wall" with photos and drawings of community jobs.
2	10–18	Coins and counting	Coins have names. Some coins are worth more.	A coin-sorting mat and a "which is more" pair-up game.
3	19–27	Putting things in order	Things happen in order.	A 3-picture sequence book the child makes (sandwich, hand-washing, helper at work).
4	28–36	Cash's Cafe	We take turns and finish our job.	The class-wide Cash's Cafe dramatic play, ending with a Family Visit Day.

The **Capstone is class-wide, not individual.** It is a sequence of dramatic-play sessions that grows into a "Cash's Cafe" set up in the classroom corner. Children rotate through three roles: shopkeeper, customer, helper (the one who keeps the cafe tidy). On the final day, families visit, and each child tells one grown-up about one helper they noticed in the community.

The 8 strand outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

By the end of Kindergarten, a Cash to Company student will be able to:



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

- **BAVC** — I can name three businesses in my community and tell one way each business helps people.
- **PSIG** — I can describe a problem someone has (e.g., wet feet in the rain) and name one thing a business could make or do to help.
- **MFL** — I can identify a penny, nickel, dime, and quarter, and tell which is worth more in a pair.
- **CBM** — I can match a business sign or logo (pizza shop, dentist, fire station) to what that business does.
- **OSO** — I can put three pictures of "making a sandwich" in the right order.
- **LTO** — I can take turns being the "shopkeeper" and the "customer" in classroom dramatic play and use kind words for both roles.

- **ESL** — I can name one safety rule for a worker (helmet, hand-washing, walk don't run) and tell why it matters.
- **LRCI** — I can finish a small classroom job (passing out napkins for "Cash's Cafe") and tell whether I did it the way it was supposed to be done.

Each outcome is named in at least one lesson and at least one Cash video.

Vocabulary roadmap (10 simple terms)

We keep the list short on purpose. Words go on the **Word Wall** with a picture next to each. Children point and say. Repetition is the lesson.

1. **helper** — someone who does a job that helps us
2. **business** — a place or person that helps people (often for money)
3. **shopkeeper** — the helper who runs a store
4. **customer** — the person who comes to a store
5. **coin** — a small round piece of money
6. **penny** — the brown one, worth one cent
7. **nickel** — the bigger silver one, worth five cents
8. **dime** — the small silver one, worth ten cents
9. **quarter** — the big silver one, worth twenty-five cents
10. **in order** — first, next, last
11. **kind words** — please, thank you, you're welcome

12. **safety rule** — a rule that keeps a worker safe

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Standards alignment (verbatim from Standards Alignment Map)

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-1:** Identify various forms of income and reasons people work. (Cash teaches this at K via "people in our community do jobs that help us.")
- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-1:** Distinguish between needs and wants. (K-friendly: snacks vs. toys.)
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4 Benchmark:** People have many different types of jobs from which to choose.
- **CCSS-Math K.MD.A.2 / K.CC.B.4:** Counting and comparing — applied to coin recognition and "which is more."
- **CCSS-ELA RL.K.3:** Identify characters, settings, and major events in a story — applied to picture books like A Chair for My Mother.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize one's own emotions about classroom roles (customer, worker).

- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify the goods and services that people in the community produce and those that are produced in other communities.

Honest gap (named, not papered over). Entrepreneurship-as-noticing-need is not named at K in Jump$tart or CEE. We teach it because it scaffolds the program that follows. We are honest that we are reaching beyond the published K benchmarks here, in service of the spine.

Picture-first design (visual notes for the printed book)

Every spread of every K book in this program is at least 60% illustration. Text is short. Type is large.

[VISUAL NOTE — cover spread] Cash, the coin-shaped mascot, stands on a sidewalk. Behind Cash: a pizza shop, a fire station, a dentist sign with a tooth on it, and a small library cart. The word "HELPERS" arches across the top in big warm yellow.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 1 opener] A child looking up at a mail carrier. The mail carrier waves. Cash is in the corner with a notepad, smiling.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 2 opener] Four big coins on a table — penny, nickel, dime, quarter — labeled. A child reaches for the dime.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 3 opener] Three boxes in a row, like comic panels: bread on the counter, peanut butter going on, sandwich on a plate. Arrows from box to box.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 4 opener] Cash's Cafe in the corner of a classroom. A child wears a paper apron. Another child holds a pretend coin. A small sign reads "OPEN."

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **No family income probing.** We never ask "how much money does your family have?" or "what does your parent do for work?" If a child volunteers a job, we receive it warmly and move on. We do not survey occupations.
- **Snacks and food.** Many helpers students will name run food businesses. Avoid framing any food as "junk" or "good." Allergies are real. Use pretend food (felt, paper) in dramatic play.
- **Real coins around small children.** Use rubber or laminated coin cards for daily handling. Pull out a small set of real coins only with adult supervision and clear hand-washing routines after.
- **Family structure.** "Family" is the people who care for you. Helpers at home can be a parent, grandparent, foster caregiver, older sibling, anyone. Frame openly.

- **Safety rules.** When children name "safety rules for workers," accept any honest answer (helmet, gloves, walk don't run, hand-washing, look both ways). Do not press for a perfect example.

Materials and tools (year)

- A class set of coin cards (laminated, 4 coin types × at least 6 cards each).
- A small set of real coins (in a sealed jar, supervised use).
- Felt or paper pretend food for the cafe.
- Small paper aprons (4–6) and a paper "OPEN/CLOSED" sign.
- The Helpers Wall — a section of bulletin board with photos and drawings.
- A class read-aloud library (5–7 picture books — see anchor texts below).
- Cash short videos — eight across the year, 1:30–2:00 each.
- The Grade K Student Activity Book — picture-first, mostly drawing pages.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Anchor texts (read-alouds; teacher-selected, classroom library)

- A Chair for My Mother (Vera B. Williams) — saving coins for a family helper item.
- Last Stop on Market Street (Matt de la Peña) — community helpers and noticing.
- The Doorbell Rang (Pat Hutchins) — sharing and counting.
- Pete the Cat: Pete's Big Lunch — sequencing.
- Officer Buckle and Gloria (Peggy Rathmann) — safety rules.

(Substitute any equivalent picture books available in the school library; the moves matter more than the specific titles.)

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

- **No grade before Kindergarten** — this is where Cash starts. The job here is to install the noticing muscle and the four coin names.
- **Reaches forward to Grade 1** — Grade 1's theme is "Businesses make things or do things." In Grade K, students notice that businesses help. In Grade 1, they sort businesses into "makes a thing" or "does a thing." The bridge is sturdy: a child who has spent a year saying "the librarian helps" and "the pizza shop helps" is ready to ask "does the librarian make a thing or do a thing?"

- **Vertical strands.** Each of the eight strands has a Grade K outcome (above). The four units braid them together — for example, Unit 4 (Cash's Cafe) centers LTO and LRCI with strong supporting beams from CBM, OSO, and ESL.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You do not need to know anything about business to teach this year. You need to be willing to point and say "there's a helper" fifty times until the children point first. Cash will do the heavy lifting on the videos. The lesson plans take the pacing decisions off your plate. Your highest-leverage move all year is the **noticing routine**: at the start of every Cash to Company block, ask the room, "who helped you today?" and listen. By Week 12, they will be telling you before you ask.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade K

Added in the deep-think review pass to lift this grade from "competent" to "amazing." Use these alongside the original content; they do not replace anything above.

Multi-class branching scenario — "Maya and the wet feet"

A Grade K story that runs across 2-3 sessions, picture-first, with class-vote branches.

- **Day 1.** Show three pictures: rain falling, Maya's wet socks, Maya's sad face. Ask: "What's Maya's problem?" Children answer chorally. "Wet feet. Sad." Affirm: "Maya has a problem. Maybe a helper-business can help."
- **Day 2.** Show three helper cards: a shoe-store helper with rain boots; a sock-store helper with extra socks; a towel-store helper with a small towel. Ask: "Which helper helps Maya the most?" Class votes by walking to the card on the floor. Three children, one per card, say one sentence about why their helper is the one. No "wrong answer."
- **Day 3.** Whichever helper wins the vote, the class re-enacts the helper helping Maya. "How can I help you, Maya?" "Please may I have rain boots?" "Yes, here are your boots." "Thank you." Use the kind words. End with: "Helpers help. Notice, notice, notice."

This branching scenario practices BAVC (helpers help), CBM (matching helper to need), and LTO (kind words in roles), all in one arc. Repeatable with new problems through the year (lost mittens, jam on the shirt, a missing crayon).

Cross-grade bridge to Grade 1

Add to the year-end Family Visit Day: tell each family that next year, their child will sort helpers into "makes a thing" or "does a thing." "We noticed helpers this year. Next year, we sort them." This sets up the Grade 1 sort without homework, without expectation, just a one-sentence preview.

Where Cash voice held — quick check

Spot-check sample lines in the Lesson Plans to confirm they pass the K-2 voice rule (6-10 words, concrete, repeated):

- "Helpers help. Notice, notice, notice." — 4 words then 3 repetitions. Passes.
- "What did the helper do?" — 5 words. Passes.
- "Which coin is more?" — 4 words. Passes.
- "Please may I have a pretzel?" — 6 words. Passes.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim from Standards Alignment Map)

This grade centers the following benchmarks (verbatim quotes from `_master/00_Standards_Alignment_Map.md`):

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-1:** "Identify various forms of income and reasons people work."
- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-1:** "Distinguish between needs and wants."
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4 Benchmark:** "People have many different types of jobs from which to choose."
- **CCSS-Math K.MD.A.2 / K.CC.B.4:** Counting and comparing — applied to coin recognition and "which is more."
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- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize ones own emotions about classroom roles (customer, worker).
- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** "Identify the goods and services that people in the community produce and those that are produced in other communities."
- **Honest gap:** Entrepreneurship-as-noticing-need is not named at K in Jump$tart/CEE; we teach it because it scaffolds what the program builds toward.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

Each cell below is verbatim from `_master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md`. By end of Kindergarten, a student can:

- **BAVC:** "I can name three businesses in my community and tell one way each business helps people."
- **PSIG:** "I can describe a problem someone has (e.g., wet feet in the rain) and name one thing a business could make or do to help."
- **MFL:** "I can identify a penny, nickel, dime, and quarter, and tell which is worth more in a pair."
- **CBM:** "I can match a business sign or logo (pizza shop, dentist, fire station) to what that business does."
- **OSO:** "I can put three pictures of making a sandwich in the right order."
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- **LRCI:** "I can finish a small classroom job (passing out napkins for Cashs Cafe) and tell whether I did it the way it was supposed to be done."

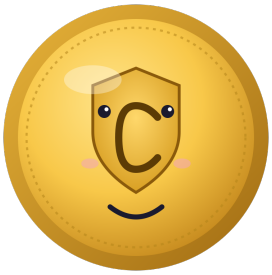
CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Kindergarten)

For students ready for more depth (the "I-already-know-coins" student), name specific extensions, not "push toward more":

- **Coin extension:** Half-dollar and dollar coin recognition. Same compare-by-value rule.
- **Helper extension:** "Find two helpers who help the same person — the dentist and the dentists helper." Sets up Grade 6s value chain.
- **Cashs Cafe extension:** Be the "captain" of one Cafe shift; assign two jobs to peers. (This is the seed of Grade 4s 5-minute meeting.)
- **Story extension:** Read Last Stop on Market Street and identify three helpers in the book.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade K